

Scorched 3D (Fun, 47.4 MB)

Scorched Earth is a classic DOS game which has been reinvented to become a simple turn-based artillery game called 'Scorched 3D'. This game has a lively three-dimensional landscape that includes animated jets, naval vessels, water, birds, tanks and projectiles. Other enhancements include LAN, Internet play and music. It is a real-time strategy game, in which players have to counter-attack each other with creative accessories, shields and tactics. An open source game, Scorched 3D can be played with 24 other players at a time. It is available for both Windows and Linux. For more information, visit <http://www.scorched3d.co.uk/>.

**Audacity** (Utility, 6.3 MB)

Audacity is a digital audio editor and recording application that allows you to play songs directly, record songs, LP, voice or tape. It also allows you to edit songs and export audio to MP3 or other file formats. Besides MP3, it supports WAV, AIFF, Ogg Vorbis, in addition to all other file formats supported by the libsndfile library. The software requires a LAME encoder that can be downloaded separately. It has a vast array of digital effects and plug-ins. Audacity also allows conversion of cassette tapes or records into digital tracks without com-



promising on sound quality. It works on Windows, Mac OS X and Linux. For more information, visit <http://audacity.sourceforge.net/>.

XBMC (Utility, 81.0 MB)

XBMC is the ideal home playback system for audio and video. It is open source and comes with many features. The XBMC media centre was formerly known as the Xbox media centre and was available only in Xbox consoles. Now it is available for Linux, MS Windows, Mac OS, Apple TV and Xbox, and almost 200 developers and translators are making it open source.

XBMC is built with OpenGL interface and written in C++ language. It is a resource-demanding application and in order to perform adequately, a minimum of 2GHz CPU and 2 GB of RAM with OpenGL graphics support are required. XBMC has media management, fluid interface, plug-ins, extensibility visualisation (songs, pictures, etc), enabling you to access them in a systematic fashion. The fluid interface is completely customisable through downloaded or user-created skins.

This application is easy to use, has an eye-catching interface and proffers media streaming capabilities. It has plenty of navigation options and expandability, but a few limitations: It is resource-hungry and does not support USB 2.0 and multisession media. For more information, visit www.xbmc.org.

**Songbird** (Utility, 13.0 MB)

Developed by Rob Lord, the Songbird is an open

source audio player which lets users browse the Web as well. It employs the GStreamer media framework and is licensed by GPLv2. Its features support various file formats like MP3, AAC, Ogg Vorbis, FLAC, Apple Lossless and WMA.

It has the ability to play Apple FairPlay-encoded audio on Windows and Mac platforms via hooks into QuickTime (authorisation takes place in iTunes). With this audio player, you can download MP3 files, browse the Web and use/create bookmarks. It enables you to scan the entire hard drive and lists the songs in its software interface. Besides, it has a 10-band equaliser and integration with last.fm. The Songbird can run on Windows, Linux and Mac. For more information, visit <http://getsongbird.com>.

**Avidemux** (Utility, 9.7 MB)

Avidemux is a free open source software for multi-purpose video editing and processing. It is written in C/C++ language, using GTK+, Qt graphics or command line interface. Its version 2.5 is now available.

Avidemux comes with an uncomplicated and easy-to-use user interface. Its features include WYSIWYG cutting, appending, filters and re-encoding. The software contains some filters that are ported from MPlayer and Avisynth. Avidemux can also mux and demux audio streams in and out of video files, either through re-encoding or by using direct copy mode. It has built-in processing, both for optical character recognition (OCR) and soft suitable formats. While it is a GUI program, it can be run through command

line as well. For more information, visit <http://avidemux.org/>.

